

Gary Fishell

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SUMMARY

Big-data and search engineer who turns massive, real-time datasets into measurable product impact at scale.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer II, Sidecar Health

Jul 2024 – Present

Health-insurance startup — real-time big-data systems powering provider search and pricing | San Diego, CA

- Architected a concurrent Python/AWS pipeline (SQS, Lambda, EventBridge, S3) ingesting **7M+ providers and 2M+ locations** into Elasticsearch/MySQL in under an hour — replacing a multi-day manual process and powering the search that drives company MLR.
- Designed a synthetic-location system (address normalization + dedup) that made **2M+ previously unsearchable providers findable**, verified at 100% via dashboards I built for the product team.
- Diagnosed cross-team SQL upsert bottlenecks and recommended concurrency + indexing fixes projected to cut a multi-day upload to one day.
- Helped migrate serial Step Functions pipelines to concurrent SQS-based processing, owning the tradeoffs.
- Resolved multiple P1 incidents as primary on-call and guided other engineers as triage SME.
- Built Datadog dashboards and on-call playbooks enforcing a 2-hour ingestion SLA on every new-data run.
- Built Pydantic validation enforcing vendor data contracts, improving upstream data quality over time.
- Led a search-analytics service feeding DBT models to reveal which results drive member engagement.
- Mentor a data-engineering hire by scoping and delegating workstreams to grow their ownership.
- Author ADRs for the synthetic-location design and the deferral of unused third-party data fields.

Cloud Software Engineer, Hewlett Packard (HP)

Jul 2022 – Jul 2024

San Diego, CA

- Cut printer-to-service latency **50%** by introducing dedicated processing nodes for high-priority traffic.
- Implemented core business logic in the Rails service powering HP's multi-billion-dollar ink-subscription SaaS.
- Led a new Spring Boot service to Azure DevOps and provisioned AWS infra with Terraform.
- Architected a JSON passthrough service unifying printer communication across 3 generations.
- Built Resque jobs that detected and resynced user-data inconsistencies against external APIs.
- Owned production triage on-call and hardened reliability by refactoring the JUnit test suite.

Software Engineer, Northrop Grumman

Dec 2018 – Jul 2022

San Diego, CA

- Migrated a mission-critical Java Swing interface to a React/Redux web UI, improving operator usability.
- Automated **50%** of integration testing with Eggplant and Selenium across web components.
- Persisted embedded-device radio queries to a database and exposed them through a web UI.
- Served as apprentice scrum master and cut customer wait time via onsite release-candidate triage.

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, C++

Backend & Data: Spring Boot, Rails, REST APIs, MySQL, DynamoDB, Elasticsearch/OpenSearch

Cloud & Pipelines: AWS (Lambda, SQS, EventBridge, S3), Terraform, Pydantic, DBT, Kafka-style pub/sub

Frontend: React, Next.js, Redux, HTML/CSS, Sass

Tooling: Docker, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, Git, CI/CD, JUnit/RSpec, Agile/Scrum

EDUCATION

San Diego State University — B.S. Computer Science, *Summa Cum Laude*

2017 – 2020